Period/year	Concept/ development	Inventor/ developer	Technological principle	Significance/ contribution
1917	*Ruston Proctor Aerial Target*	A. M. Low/Ruston Proctor Aircraft Co. (United Kingdom)	Early radio-controlled powered monoplane.	Among the first successful applications of remote-controlled powered flight.
1918	*Kettering Bug*	Charles Kettering (United States)	Mechanically pre-programed flight using engine revolution counters	Pioneered automated flight distance control; precursor to modern cruise missiles.
1935	*Queen Bee*	De Havilland Aircraft Co. (United Kingdom)	Radio-controlled training aircraft.	First operational UAV used for gunnery practice; origin of the term “drone.”
1939–1945	*Radioplane OQ-2*	Reginald Denny Industries (United States)	Radio-controlled, catapult-launched aerial target.	First mass-produced UAV, marking the transition from experimental